

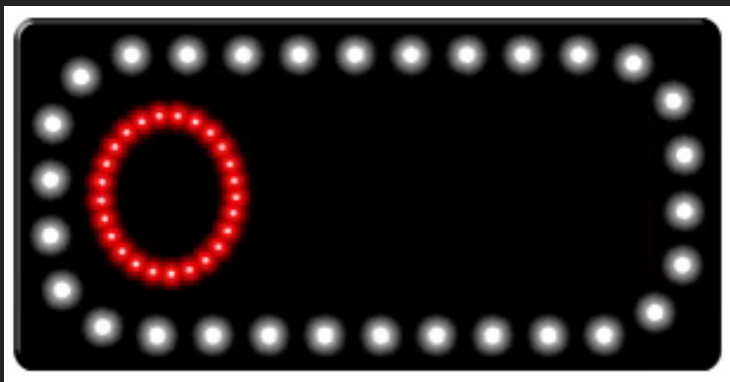
Class 9: Aspects of Social Movement Activity

Social movement coalitions

AUTHOR

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Opening notes



Presentation groups

December

January

Presentations line-up

Date	Presenters	Method
4 Dec:		TBD
11 Dec:		TBD
18 Dec:		TBD

State responses

- opening questions
- overview
- one policy change example
- repression/social control
- DE state responses to climate movement
 - FFF and LG



Opening questions

How (in what different ways) can state actors respond to movements?

Who/which state actor is taking action?

What kind of action is it? How visible is it?

State responses overview

- ignore / dismiss
- oppose
- accommodate

State responses overview

- ignore / dismiss
- oppose
 - close opportunities ('problem depletion')
 - 'channel', restrict access to resources
 - repress, apply force
- accommodate
 - encourage institutionalisation
 - engage in relevant decision-making processes
 - change policy

One policy change example (Jones 2022)

anyone know what this place is?



One policy change example (Jones 2022)

- Valley of the Fallen (incl., Catholic basilica), outside Madrid
- monument constructed under Franco, using forced/convict labour
- burial place for Franco (exhumed 24.10.2019) and Primo de Rivera (exhumed 23.4.2023)
- *Ley de Memoria Histórica*:



recognises and broadens “the rights and establishes measures in favour of those who suffered persecution or violence during the civil war and the dictatorship.”

3 dimensions of repression/social control (Earl 2003)

```
library(tidyr)
library(kableExtra)
```



```
table_data <- tribble(
  ~a, ~b, ~c, ~d,
  "Identity of repressive agent", "State agents tightly connected with national political
  "Character of repressive action", "Coercion (e.g., use of tear gas and rubber bullets)"
  "Whether repressive action is observable", "Observable (i.e., overt; e.g., Tiananmen Sq
)

kable(table_data, "html", escape = FALSE,
  col.names = c("", "", "", "")) %>%
  kable_styling(bootstrap_options = c("striped", "hover", "responsive"), font_size = 24)
  column_spec(1, bold = TRUE)
```

Identity of repressive agent	State agents tightly connected with national political elites (e.g., military units)	State agents loosely connected with national political elites (e.g., local police departments)	Private agents (e.g., counter-demonstrators)
Character of repressive action	Coercion (e.g., use of tear gas and rubber bullets)	Channelling (e.g., restrictions on registered organisations)	
Whether repressive action is observable	Observable (i.e., overt; e.g., Tiananmen Square)	Unobserved (i.e., covert or latent; e.g., COINTELPRO)	

What sort of repression/social control in cases do you know of? Was it effective? Why/How?

DE climate movement - FFF



Der Mitorganisator der "Fridays For Future-Bewegung", Jakob Blasel aus Kronshagen, stellte am Dienstag die Forderungen der Bewegung für den Schutz des Klimas persönlich an die Bundeskanzlerin.
© Quelle: dpa



Das Gespräch am Rande des UN-Klimagipfels

Foto: dpa

- March 2019: Chancellor Merkel praises FFF ([link](#))
- April 2019: government minister (for Economy and Energy, Peter Altmeier) requests to speak at FFF demo (rejected by organisers) ([link](#))
- August 2020: Chancellor Merkel meets with FFF representatives ([link](#))
- March 2021: constitutional court (*Bundesverfassungsgericht*) declares federal climate protection law (*Bundes-Klimaschutzgesetz*) insufficient, requiring more government action

- influence on United Nations Climate Change conferences, COPs 25-28

DE climate movement - Letzte Generation

- 2022: Green party (potential elite allies) distance themselves from LG
- December 2022/May 2023: police searches of LG properties, related to prosecutions ([link](#) and [link](#))



- April 2023: violent police tactics to remove blockaders ([link](#))
 - 'pain grips' (*Schmerzgriffe*): wristlocks and other 'control/restraint holds'
- use of **preventive detention** in Bayern ([link](#)) and calls for it elsewhere by police union chief ([link](#))
- politicians, some from governing parties, referring to 'climate terrorists' (*Klimaterroristen*) and 'climate RAF' (*Klima-RAF*)

Poll: State responses



Take the survey at <https://forms.gle/jkBAGEAx5Ub9LeoT6>

- good when state agrees to protest demands?
 - non-violent protest inviolable?
 - state response to movement disruption of services?
-
- is state surveillance of a movement ever acceptable?
 - what determines whether movement treated as 'threatening'?
 - what typically happens after a state violently represses a movement?
 - states respond more harshly to 'marginalised group' movements?

```
md`## Poll results (Respondents: ${respondentCount})`
```

Poll results (Respondents: 2)

```
import { liveGoogleSheet } from "@jimjamslam/live-google-sheet";
import { aq, op } from "@uwdata/arquero";

// UPDATE THE LINK FOR A NEW POLL
surveyResults = liveGoogleSheet(
  "https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/e/" +
    "2PACX-1vT3CB5F0YxqtGGIZf0Ehdhime5_ChcJ9Uau4s00ETYdrpH0y25pqGt5cNyGc9Ig51LmkWjBfHDzfZ" +
    "pub?gid=1350101088&single=true&output=csv",
  10000, 1, 8); // adjust the last number to select all relevant columns

respondentCount = surveyResults.length;
```

good when state agrees to protest demands?

```
agreesCounts = aq.from(surveyResults)
  .select("agrees")
  .groupby("agrees")
  .count()
  .derive({ measure: d => "" })

// Calculate the maximum count from your data
agrees_maxCountRE = Math.max(...agreesCounts)

plot_agrees = Plot.plot({
  marks: [
    Plot.barY(agreesCounts, {
      x: "agrees",
      y: "count",
      fill: "agrees",
      stroke: "black",
      strokeWidth: 1
    }),
    Plot.ruleY([respondentCount], { stroke:
  ],
  color: {
    domain: [
      "Yes",
      "No",
      "Maybe"
    ],
    range: [
      "forestgreen",
      "darkred",
      "goldenrod"
    ]
  },
  marginBottom: 80,
  x: { label: "", tickSize: 2, tickRotate: -
    domain: ["Yes", "No", "Maybe"]
  },
  y: {
    label: "",
    tickSize: 10,
    tickFormat: d => d,
    tickValues: Array.from(
      new Set(agreesCounts.objects().map(d =>
    ).sort((a, b) => a - b),
    domain: [0, agrees_maxCountRE]
  },
  facet: { data: agreesCounts, x: "measure",
  marginLeft: 60,
  style: {
    width: 1600,
```

determines whether movement treated as
'threatening'?

```
determinesCounts = aq.from(surveyResults)
  .select("determines")
  .groupby("determines")
  .count()
  .derive({ measure: d => "" })

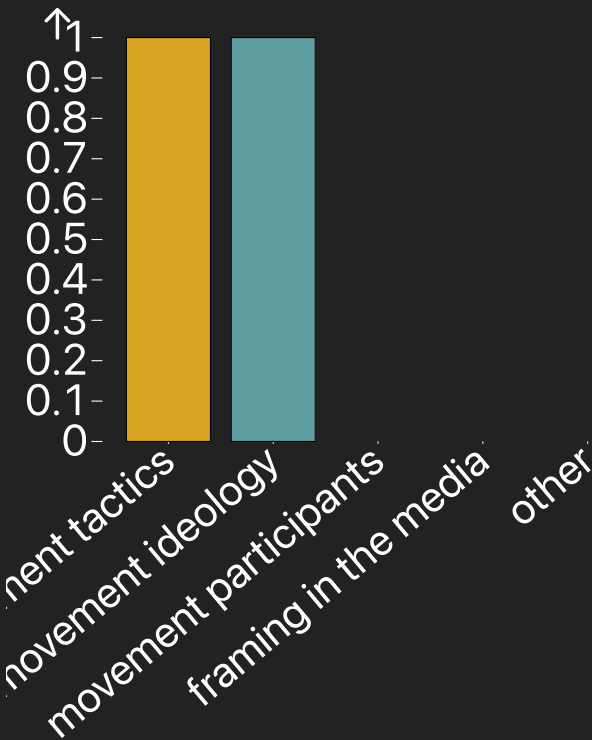
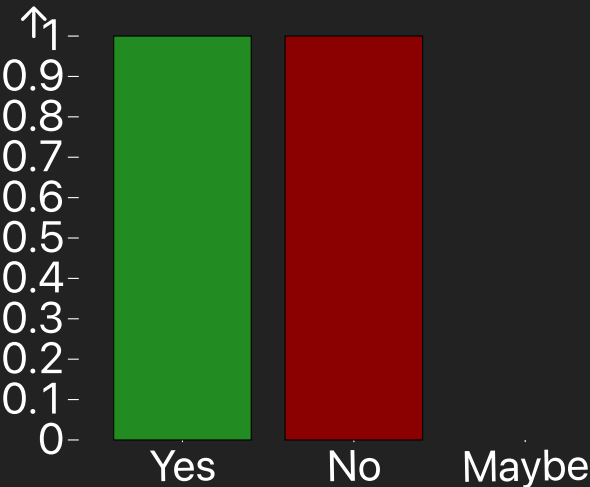
// Calculate the maximum count from your data
determines_maxCountRE = Math.max(...determinesCounts)

plot_determines = Plot.plot({
  marks: [
    Plot.barY(determinesCounts, {
      x: "determines",
      y: "count",
      fill: "determines",
      stroke: "black",
      strokeWidth: 1
    }),
    Plot.ruleY([respondentCount], { stroke:
  ],
  color: {
    domain: [
      "movement tactics",
      "movement ideology",
      "movement participants",
      "framing in the media",
      "other"
    ],
    range: [
      "goldenrod",
      "cadetblue",
      "darkorange",
      "forestgreen",
      "violet"
    ]
  },
  marginBottom: 400,
  x: { label: "", tickSize: 2, tickRotate: -
    domain: ["movement tactics", "movement i
  ],
  y: {
    label: "",
    tickSize: 10,
    tickFormat: d => d,
    tickValues: Array.from(
      new Set(determinesCounts.objects().map(d =>
    ).sort((a, b) => a - b),
    domain: [0, determines_maxCountRE]
```

```
width: 2000,  
height: 500,  
fontSize: 40,  
},  
});
```

Poll - harder state responses

```
domain: [0, determines_maxCountRL]  
},  
facet: { data: determinesCounts, x: "measu  
marginLeft: 60,  
style: {  
width: 1600,  
height: 500,  
fontSize: 40,  
},  
});
```



state response to movement
disruption of services?

state surveillance of a movement
ever acceptable?

what after a state violently
represses a movement?

```
disruptsCounts = aq.from(surve
  .select("disrupts")
  .groupby("disrupts")
  .count()
  .derive({ measure: d => ""

// Calculate the maximum count
disrupts_maxCountRE = Math.max

plot_disrupts = Plot.plot({
  marks: [
    Plot.barY(disruptsCounts,
      x: "disrupts",
      y: "count",
      fill: "disrupts",
      stroke: "black",
      strokeWidth: 1
    ),
    Plot.ruleY([respondentCounts],
  ],
  color: {
    domain: [
      "remove protest",
      "remove and arrest",
      "tolerate",
      "negotiate",
      "support",
      "other"
    ],
    range: [
      "red",
      "orange",
      "yellow",
      "green",
      "blue",
      "indigo"
    ]
  },
  marginBottom: 400,
  x: { label: "", tickSize: 20,
    domain: ["remove protest",
  },
  y: {
    label: "",
    tickSize: 10,
    tickFormat: d => d,
    tickValues: Array.from(
      new Set(disruptsCounts

surveillanceCounts = aq.from(surve
  .select("surveillance")
  .groupby("surveillance")
  .count()
  .derive({ measure: d => ""

// Calculate the maximum count
surveillance_maxCountRE = Math.max

plot_surveillance = Plot.plot({
  marks: [
    Plot.barY(surveillanceCounts,
      x: "surveillance",
      y: "count",
      fill: "surveillance",
      stroke: "black",
      strokeWidth: 1
    ),
    Plot.ruleY([respondentCounts],
  ],
  color: {
    domain: [
      "Yes",
      "No",
      "Maybe"
    ],
    range: [
      "forestgreen",
      "darkred",
      "goldenrod"
    ]
  },
  marginBottom: 80,
  x: { label: "", tickSize: 20,
    domain: ["Yes", "No", "Ma
  },
  y: {
    label: "",
    tickSize: 10,
    tickFormat: d => d,
    tickValues: Array.from(
      new Set(surveillanceCounts
    ).sort((a, b) => a - b),
    domain: [0, surveillance_maxCountRE
  },
  facet: { data: surveillanceCounts
  },
  marginLeft: 60,
  style: {

repressCounts = aq.from(surve
  .select("repress")
  .groupby("repress")
  .count()
  .derive({ measure: d => ""

// Calculate the maximum count
repress_maxCountRE = Math.max

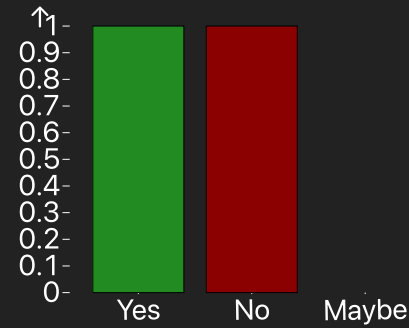
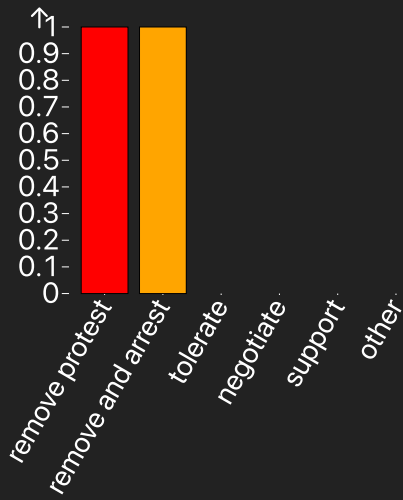
plot_repress = Plot.plot({
  marks: [
    Plot.barY(repressCounts,
      x: "repress",
      y: "count",
      fill: "repress",
      stroke: "black",
      strokeWidth: 1
    ),
    Plot.ruleY([respondentCounts],
  ],
  color: {
    domain: [
      "movement collapses",
      "movement radicalises",
      "support for movement collapse",
      "movement goes underground",
      "other"
    ],
    range: [
      "black",
      "red",
      "forestgreen",
      "navy",
      "gray"
    ]
  },
  marginBottom: 400,
  x: { label: "", tickSize: 20,
    domain: ["movement collapse
  },
  y: {
    label: "",
    tickSize: 10,
    tickFormat: d => d,
    tickValues: Array.from(
      new Set(repressCounts.count
    ).sort((a, b) => a - b),
    domain: [0, repress_maxCountRE
  },
  facet: { data: repressCounts
  },
  marginLeft: 60,
  style: {
```


Poll - motivated state responses

```
new Set(disruptsCounts.  
).sort((a, b) => a - b),  
domain: [0, disrupts_max],  
},  
facet: { data: disruptsCount  
marginLeft: 60,  
style: {  
width: 1600,  
height: 500,  
fontSize: 40,  
},  
});
```

```
style: {  
width: 1600,  
height: 500,  
fontSize: 40,  
},  
});
```

```
domain: [0, repress_max],  
},  
facet: { data: repressCount  
marginLeft: 60,  
style: {  
width: 1600,  
height: 500,  
fontSize: 40,  
},  
});
```



If yes, when?



states respond more harshly to 'marginalised group' movements?

non-violent protest inviolable?

```
marginalisedCounts = aq.from(surveyResults)
  .select("marginalised")
  .groupby("marginalised")
  .count()
  .derive({ measure: d => "" })

// Calculate the maximum count from your data
marginalised_maxCountRE = Math.max(...marginalisedCounts.map(d => d.count))

plot_marginalised = Plot.plot({
  marks: [
    Plot.barY(marginalisedCounts, {
      x: "marginalised",
      y: "count",
      fill: "marginalised",
      stroke: "black",
      strokeWidth: 1
    }),
    Plot.ruleY([respondentCount], { stroke: "black" })
  ],
  color: {
    domain: [
      "Strongly disagree",
      "Disagree",
      "Neutral",
      "Agree",
      "Strongly agree"
    ],
    range: [
      "red",
      "pink",
      "lightgrey",
      "lightgreen",
      "forestgreen"
    ]
  },
  marginBottom: 180,
  x: { label: "", tickSize: 2, tickRotate: -45,
    domain: ["Strongly disagree", "Disagree", "Neutral", "Agree", "Strongly agree"]
  },
  y: {
    label: "count",
    tickSize: 10,
    tickFormat: d => d,
    tickValues: Array.from(
      new Set(marginalisedCounts.objects().map(d => d.count))
    ).sort((a, b) => a - b),
    domain: [0, marginalised_maxCountRE]
  }
})
```

```
protectedCounts = aq.from(surveyResults)
  .select("protected")
  .groupby("protected")
  .count()
  .derive({ measure: d => "" })

// Calculate the maximum count from your data
protected_maxCountRE = Math.max(...protectedCounts.map(d => d.count))

plot_protected = Plot.plot({
  marks: [
    Plot.barY(protectedCounts, {
      x: "protected",
      y: "count",
      fill: "protected",
      stroke: "black",
      strokeWidth: 1
    }),
    Plot.ruleY([respondentCount], { stroke: "black" })
  ],
  color: {
    domain: [
      "Strongly disagree",
      "Disagree",
      "Neutral",
      "Agree",
      "Strongly agree"
    ],
    range: [
      "red",
      "pink",
      "lightgrey",
      "lightgreen",
      "forestgreen"
    ]
  },
  marginBottom: 180,
  x: { label: "", tickSize: 2, tickRotate: -45,
    domain: ["Strongly disagree", "Disagree", "Neutral", "Agree", "Strongly agree"]
  },
  y: {
    label: "count",
    tickSize: 10,
    tickFormat: d => d,
    tickValues: Array.from(
      new Set(protectedCounts.objects().map(d => d.count))
    ).sort((a, b) => a - b),
    domain: [0, protected_maxCountRE]
  }
})
```

Research closer look

- Bernitzen and Weisskircher (2016) - mobilisation differences and state responses
 - PEGIDA background
 - research questions and design
 - cases and data collection
 - findings
 - discussion question

```
facet: { data: protectedCounts, x: "measur  
marginLeft: 140,  
style: {  
width: 1350,  
height: 500,  
}  
});
```



PEGIDA background: movement framing

PEGIDA as a 'serious
civil rights

movement'? (H.C.

Strache)

Even if protest is anti-democratic/
hateful/discriminatory?

PEGIDA background: a demonstration in Wien

Wien, 2 February 2015



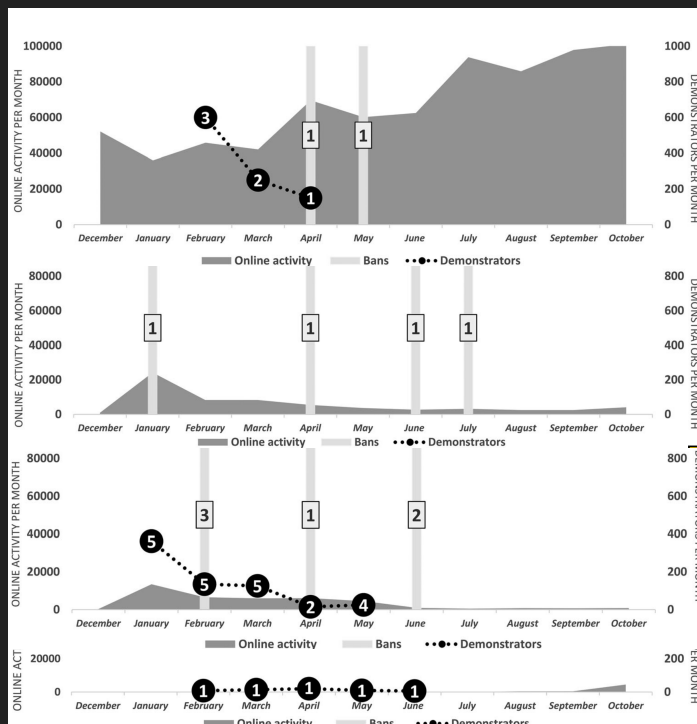
Berntzen and Weisskircher (2016) - RQ

- why did PEGIDA mobilize to some extent in Austria and Norway, while failing in Sweden and Switzerland?

case selection: two countries from economically and culturally similar regions (German-speaking Central Europe [Switzerland and Austria] and Scandinavia [Norway and Sweden]), each with variation on the 'dependent variable' of street mobilisation

- sort of paired 'most similar systems design' (MSSD)
- key **IVs**: state bans, parliamentary strength of the radical right, counter-mobilisation by anti-racist groups
 - why these IVs? are there other important factors? what are the hypothesised effects?

Berntzen and Weisskircher (2016) - cases



thickness of grey stream shows aggregate online activity by PEGIDA groups. Circles indicate protesters in month, number inside circle shows demos per month

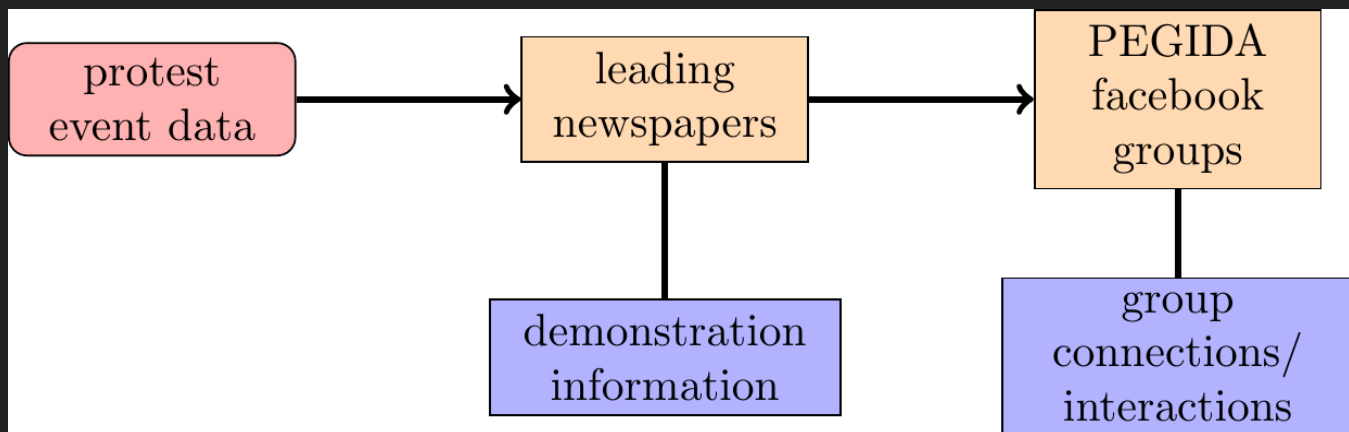
Austria: significant mobilisation

Switzerland: insignificant mobilisation

Norway: significant mobilisation

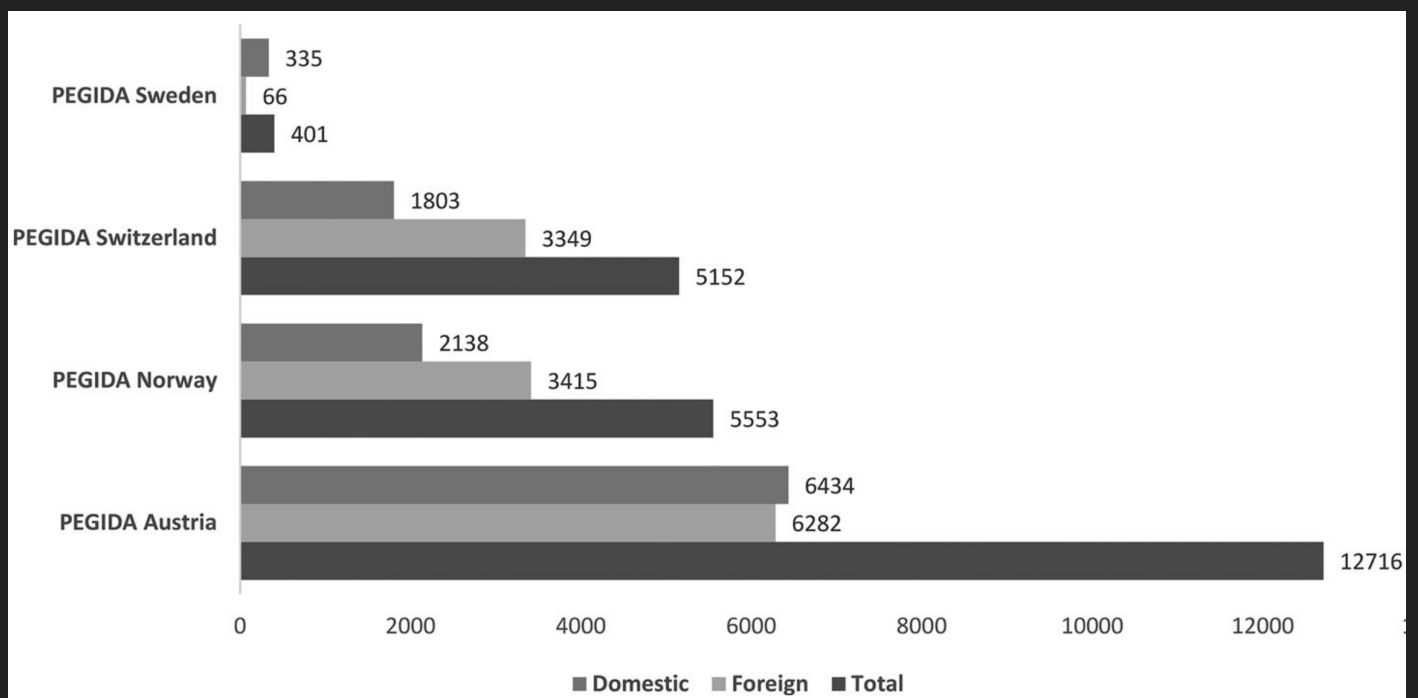
Sweden: insignificant mobilisation

Berntzen and Weisskircher (2016) - data collection



gaps in this data collection? anything other data needed?

PEGIDA Facebook memberships



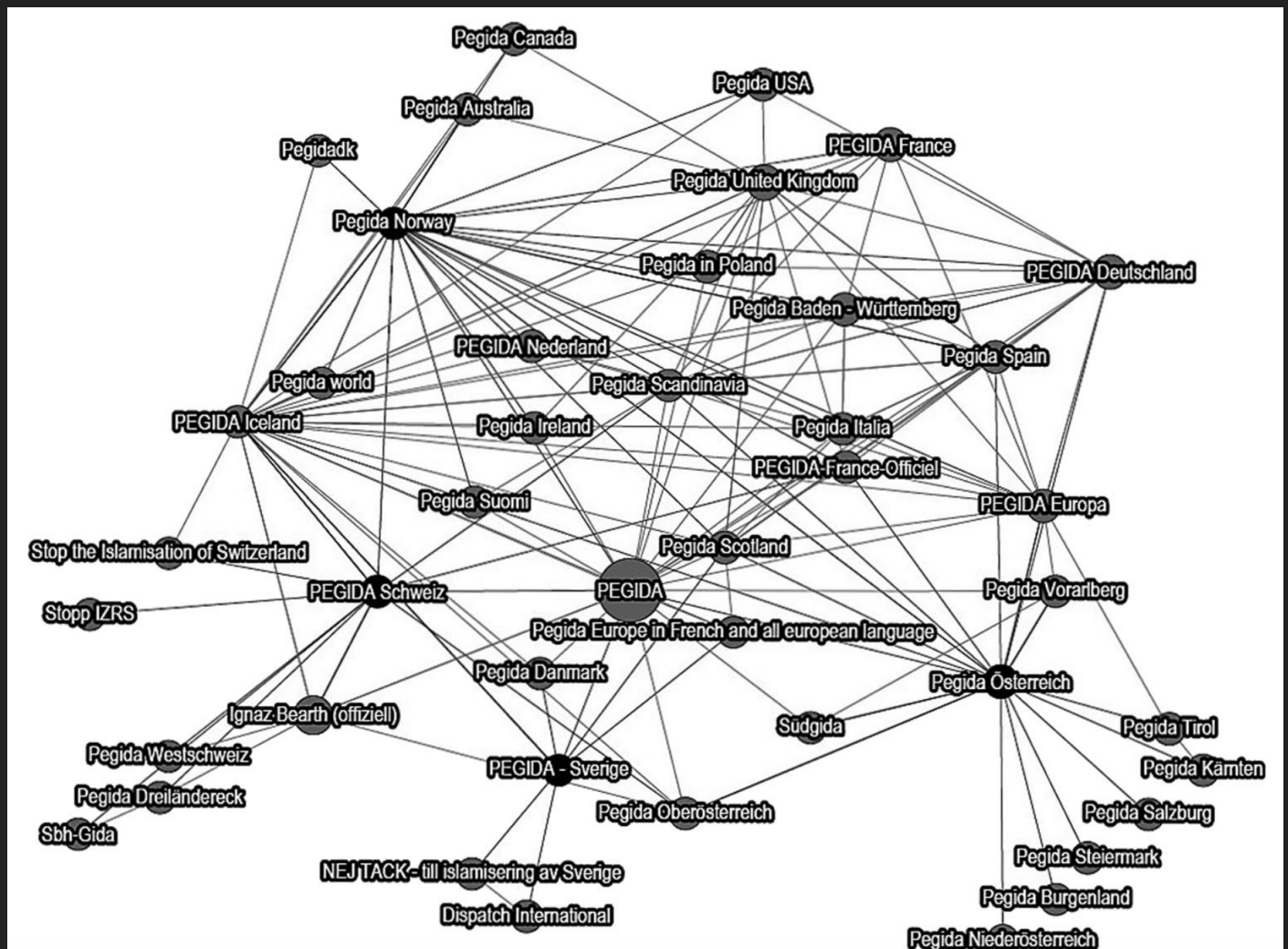
Berntzen and Weisskircher (2016) - findings

- supports *negative impact of established radical right parties on street mobilisation*
- no strong finding on *counter-mobilisation*:

“it is possible that the massive level of resistance has curtailed PEGIDA to a certain extent by making it costlier for people to march under their banner. Nevertheless, this cannot explain cross-national

variation as anti-racists mobilised strongly in all four countries”

Berntzen and Weisskircher (2016) - network



Austrian group: largest, most popular (ties to 11 other PEGIDA groups)

Norwegian group: low relevance in the wider community

Swiss group: many national ties, few external ties

Swedish group: few connections

Berntzen and Weisskircher (2016) - findings

Attempts to **mobilise and spread propaganda online** by the transnational radical right are therefore **vulnerable to police and state bans**, especially if they are **put in place at an early stage** in their mobilisation efforts. This lays bare the potential for curtailing far-right activism in multiple arenas by targeting and denying them the opportunity of rallying and getting attention through street activism.

Berntzen and Weisskircher (2016) - findings

- **Sweden PEGIDA**: restrictively policed due to high counter-mobilisation
 - new mobilisation: no strong benefit of pre-existing radical right activism; in all other cases, *PEGIDA* label was used by established radical right actors
- **Switzerland PEGIDA**: protests banned by local authorities
 - banning demonstrations (offline) also negatively impacted online activism
- **Norway PEGIDA**: outgrowth of pre-existing radical right activism
 - bans on demonstrations in Oslo—also negatively impacted online activism
- **Austria PEGIDA**: deeply embedded in national and transnational far-right scene, some support from FPÖ (large, radical right political party)
 - establishing stable online presence reshapes (expands) online far-right scene

...

- counter-mobilisation and radical right party strength do not explain differences in mobilisation—state action (esp. banning) does
 - are you convinced by this?

Berntzen and Weisskircher (2016) - discussion question

All PEGIDA events in Austria were met with much greater countermobilisation. Some PEGIDA activists were reported to the police because of engagement in National Socialist activities, such as Hitler salutes.

Is counter-mobilisation needed to provoke a state response?

...

some random researcher strongly contending 'yes': Zeller (2021), Zeller (2022), Zeller and Vaughan (2024), Zeller (2025)

...

to be continued with next session, on 'counter-mobilisation'

Any questions, concerns, feedback for this class?

Anonymous feedback here: <https://forms.gle/AjHt6fcnwZxkSg4X8>

Alternatively, please send me an email: m.zeller@lmu.de

References

- Berntzen, Lars Erik, and Manès Weisskircher. 2016. "Anti-Islamic PEGIDA Beyond Germany: Explaining Differences in Mobilisation." *Journal of Intercultural Studies* 37 (6): 556–73. <https://doi.org/10.1080/07256868.2016.1235021>.
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- . 2025. "Pragmatic Rather Than Principled: Organisational Bans in Democracies." *European Journal of Political Research* 0 (0): 1–30. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S1475676525100121y>.
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